again with China’s current leader, Xi Jinping.

The model of a one-party state, pioneered by the Russian revolutionary leader V.I. Lenin was adopted by the CPC after the establishment of the PRC in 1949. It was a highly centralized governance structure, top down and authoritarian in character. It took root in China because it mirrored the traditional centralized empires that had ruled over China for millennia. Despite several changes that have taken place in China over the past several decades, it has retained the basic character of a one-party state, with the CPC exercising authority over all institutions of the state and society. Socialism in China is a Soviet legacy, though it has been consistently modified with ‘Chinese characteristics’. The one-party Leninist state is also a feature of other Communist states such as Vietnam, Cuba and North Korea. They all share a similar political and governance structure.

The downplaying of the role of the Soviet Union, and in particular the Soviet-led Comintern, is understandable. The Soviets maintained relations with the KMT throughout the anti-Japan war and even during the civil war of 1945–49, after Japan had been defeated. The Indian revolutionary M.N. Roy, who had by now become a senior member of the Comintern, was sent to China to try and patch up relations between the CPC and the KMT, a mission which failed spectacularly, leading to the virtual decimation of the CPC. In fact, Roy’s thesis on revolution in backward semi-colonial and colonial countries had more in common with Mao’s emphasis on the role of the peasantry as the advance force of the revolution, in alliance with the urban working class. But Roy was not able to persuade the Comintern to detach itself from the KMT and fully support a ‘revolution from below’.

Several years later, while speaking to the American journalist Edgar Snow (author of *Red Star over China*) in Yanan, Mao was derogatory in his remarks about the Comintern representatives, calling Borodin a ‘blunderer’ and Roy ‘a fool . . . who just stood and talked and talked’.

The 1945 Resolution refers to the Rectification Campaign in Yanan during 1942–45. This was a major purge in the ranks of the Party led by Mao, eliminating all dissenting voices and rival factions, including through imprisonment and even execution. This was an early reflection of the